SESSION 01

Design Thinking: A Human-Centered Approach

Transforming challenges into opportunities through empathy, creativity, and rapid experimentation.

01. Introduction

Understanding the Mindset of Innovation

What is Design Thinking?

The Definition

Design Thinking is a non-linear, iterative process used to understand users, challenge assumptions, and redefine problems to create innovative solutions that are technically feasible and commercially viable.

The Essence

It shifts the focus from **"What is the problem?"** to **"Who is the person behind the problem?"**. It combines what is desirable from a human point of view with what is possible.

The Pillar: Human-Centered Design



Beyond Aesthetics

Design Thinking is not just about making products "look good." It's about deep observation and empathy for the end-user's journey. By immersing ourselves in their environment, we uncover latent needs they might not even know they have.

The 5-Phase Model (Stanford d.school)



Empathize

Research user needs.



Define

State needs & problems.



Ideate

Create ideas.



Prototype

Start building.



Test

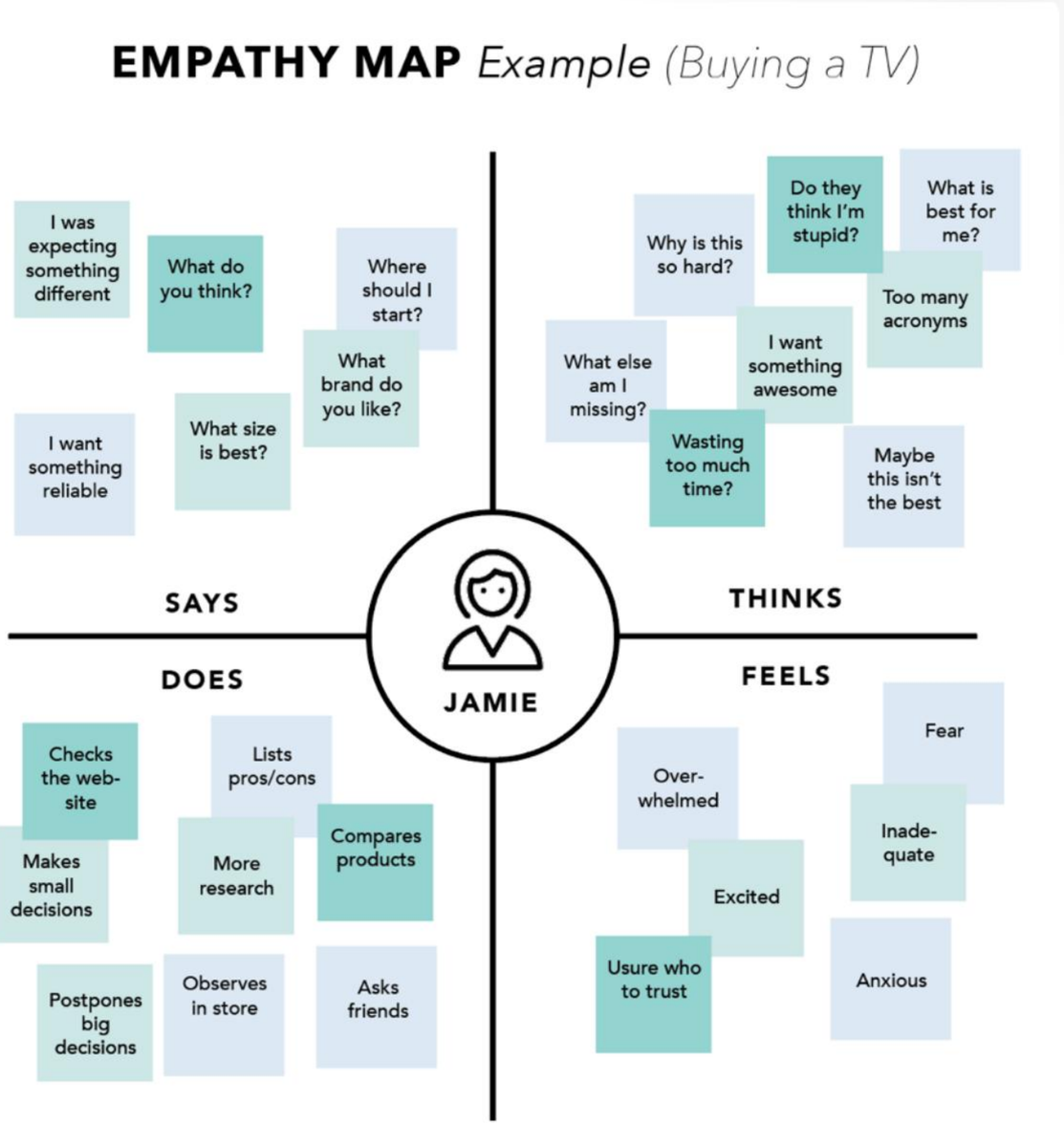
Try it out.

Step 1 & 2: Empathize & Define

Understanding the 'Why'

- **Observe:** View users and their behavior in context.
- **Engage:** Interview and interact with people.
- **Problem Statement:** Synthesize findings into a "How Might We" question.

"If I had an hour to solve a problem I'd spend 55 minutes thinking about the problem and 5 minutes thinking about solutions." — Albert Einstein



Step 3 & 4: Ideate & Prototype

Ideation: Go for quantity over quality initially. Use techniques like Brainstorming, Mind Mapping, and SCAMPER to break rigid thinking patterns.

Prototyping: Build low-fidelity representations (paper, clay, digital wireframes). Prototyping is thinking with your hands.

Fail Fast: Identifying flaws early in the prototype stage saves time and resources in the long run.

Case Study: Airbnb

The Challenge

In 2009, Airbnb was failing, making only $200 a week. Founders realized the photos were terrible.

The Solution

Using **Design Thinking**, they traveled to NY, stayed with hosts, and took professional photos. This empathetic move doubled their revenue immediately.



Design vs. Traditional Thinking

Feature	Traditional Thinking	Design Thinking
Focus	Problem & Features	Human Needs & Outcomes
Process	Linear (Waterfall)	Iterative (Cyclical)
Risk	Risk Avoidance	Risk Exploration (Fail Fast)
Success Metric	Product Perfection	User Satisfaction



Any Questions?

"The design thinking process is a journey of discovery."

Thank you for your participation!

Image Sources



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